

What I've Been Building the Last Two Years

Over the last two years, I have been doing the kind of work that does not always show up neatly on a résumé, but absolutely counts as work: writing, building, studying, organizing, surviving, and turning lived experience into something structured enough to help other people.

I have been developing a trauma-education project centered around Complex PTSD, addiction, grief, shame, survival mode, family breakdown, emotional flashbacks, fawning, freeze response, and recovery. What started as personal writing has grown into a larger body of work: part memoir, part education system, part curriculum, part business foundation, and part public resource for people who have lived through trauma but never had the language for what happened to them.

The core of that work has been my book and educational project, *From the Storm to the Fire*, along with the larger *What Really Happened* framework. I have spent the last two years writing, revising, organizing, and expanding material that explains trauma from the inside out. This has included memoir chapters, educational essays, lecture scripts, facilitator guides, definitions, curriculum modules, business descriptions, website copy, and public-facing project language.

This was not casual journaling. It was long-form development work.

I have taken the raw material of my life — childhood trauma, Complex PTSD, addiction, grief, relational abuse, divorce, family separation, relapse, survival, shame, and recovery — and worked to turn it into something understandable. I have written about how trauma lives in the body, how shame keeps people trapped, how addiction can become a “rescue boat” before it becomes a prison, how freeze can look like laziness from the outside, how fawning can make a person abandon himself to keep connection, and how people can be deeply wounded while still appearing functional.

A large part of this work has been translating clinical ideas into plain language. I have not been trying to write like a doctor. I have been trying to write like someone who has been there. The goal has been to explain complicated trauma responses in a way that a survivor, parent, teenager, peer worker, counselor, probation officer, family member, pastor, or treatment worker could actually understand.

I have also been building the *WRH Master Curriculum*, a structured trauma-education program designed to be read and taught consistently. I have worked on turning the material into complete word-for-word facilitator scripts, not loose outlines. The goal is that a class in Arkansas, New York, Germany, or anywhere else could read the same session and receive the same message. That means the work has included not just writing, but curriculum architecture: deciding session order, tone, pacing, language, repetition, emotional safety, transitions, concepts, and facilitator structure.

Alongside the writing, I have been building the public structure around the project. That has included websites, GitHub repositories, landing pages, project indexes, book pages, lecture pages, and digital archives. I have worked on organizing the material so that someone encountering the project for the first time can understand what it is, why it exists, who it is for, and how the pieces connect.

This has involved learning and using digital tools, organizing files, reviewing website layouts, improving design, creating public project pages, building repo showcases, and shaping the overall presentation of the work. I have worked on how the project looks, how it reads, how it is explained, and how someone could move through it.

I have also been developing the business side through Capitol Contracts LLC, helping shape the project into something that could eventually serve organizations, agencies, treatment programs, peer-support groups, veterans, first responders, justice-involved people, and high-barrier populations. That has included working on business descriptions, capability language, outreach emails, program summaries, target audiences, positioning, and the connection between lived-experience education and public-service needs.

In that sense, the last two years have not just been about writing a book. They have been about building an entire system around the book.

I have also created songs, spoken-word pieces, and creative prompts based on the same themes. Those pieces have explored survival, grief, faith, abandonment, addiction, family loss, and the fight to become more than the worst thing people remember about you. That creative work has helped shape the emotional voice of the larger project.

The simplest way to describe the last two years is this:

I have been building language for things I survived before I had words for them.

I have been taking the private chaos of trauma and turning it into public structure. I have been trying to create something that helps people understand the difference between a person who does not care and a person whose nervous system has been overwhelmed for years. I have been trying to explain why some people run, freeze, fawn, collapse, relapse, isolate, overwork, or self-destruct — not because they are weak, but because survival became their operating system.

This work has also been personal. It has involved facing painful parts of my own life and trying to explain them clearly without making excuses. I have worked to separate responsibility from shame. I have tried to write about addiction honestly, without glorifying it and without reducing the person to the addiction. I have tried to tell the truth about family pain, loss, divorce, fatherhood, misunderstanding, grief, and the long-term cost of living without safety.

At the same time, I have been trying to make the work useful. Not just emotional. Not just personal. Useful.

Useful to someone sitting in a room thinking they are broken.

Useful to a parent trying to understand why their adult child cannot just “snap out of it.”

Useful to a person in recovery who got clean but still does not feel free.

Useful to a peer worker trying to explain trauma without sounding clinical.

Useful to a program that wants trauma-informed language but does not know how to reach people who distrust systems.

Useful to people who have been labeled difficult, lazy, manipulative, noncompliant, addicted, unstable, or hopeless when nobody ever asked what happened before the behavior.

So the last two years have been a rebuilding period, but they have also been a production period. I have written, structured, designed, organized, revised, named, explained, and built. I have taken scattered life experience and turned it into a book, a curriculum, a public project, and the beginning of a business model.

It may not look traditional from the outside. It was not a regular nine-to-five path. But it was work.

It was creative work.

It was recovery work.

It was educational work.

It was business-development work.

It was survival turned into structure.

And it has laid the foundation for what I am building next: a trauma-education system that speaks plainly to people who have lived through hell and are tired of being explained by people who have never been there.